Combined tool induction

One record for petrol and electric strimmers and hedge cutters.

Work through these checks using your existing experience and any induction, demonstration or practice. Choose one answer per group; note support you would like on page 2. Use the correct machine manual alongside this form. **Submitting a form does not itself authorise solo use.**

My full name and email address

Machines covered - list the make/model or asset number for each tool

1. Instructions, experience and support

I have read and understood the instructions for the machines listed, with help if needed, and know where to find their manuals. I consider my experience with each machine and say where I would like a demonstration, practice or advice.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help

2. PPE - confirm once for the tools covered

I wear gloves, sturdy boots, long trousers and close-fitting clothing; tie back long hair and remove dangling items. For strimmers I use safety glasses and face protection; for hedge cutters I use the eye/face protection specified by the manual. I wear ear defenders for petrol tools and hearing protection as required for electric tools. PPE does not replace safe working methods.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help

3. Checking, returning and reporting faults

I check the machine and working area before every use, follow agreed limits and stop if unsure. I isolate before cleaning, clean and store dry as the manual directs. I report damage or unusual behaviour, tag the tool OUT OF USE and make sure it is logged. I ask for a refresher after a relevant change, incident, concern or long gap in use.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help

4. Emergency arrangements

The first-aid kit location, site address/postcode and emergency access have been explained and I know how to find them. If someone is injured, I stop and make the area safe without putting myself at risk, get first aid, call 999 or 112 for serious injury and arrange access. I report accidents and near misses to the Tool Librarian.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help

5. Petrol power - both petrol tools

I am 18 or over (society rule). I use the specified fuel/mix from a labelled can and do not start if unsure. I refuel outdoors, engine off and cooled, away from ignition sources; wipe spills, secure caps and start at least 3 m away, or farther if the manual requires. I avoid the hot exhaust, including on vertical hedge cuts, and never rest it on dry grass or against my leg. I stop the engine and wait for the cutting parts to stop before moving or putting down. Before clearing, cleaning or adjusting, I prevent restart as the manual directs, including disconnecting the spark-plug cap where specified.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help ☐ Not applicable

6. Electric power - both electric tools

Corded: I check cable, plug and casing, follow inspection/testing arrangements, use a working RCD and press its test button. I secure the cable clear of the cutting path, never cut towards it, and do not use in rain or on wet grass. **Battery:** I check the correct battery clicks home and its casing and contacts are clean and dry. I unplug or remove the battery and wait for the cutting parts to stop before clearing, adjusting, moving between areas or putting down. I never leave a running machine unattended.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help ☐ Not applicable

Combined tool induction

Tool-specific checks and one shared sign-off.

7. Strimmers - petrol and electric

I check the guard is secure, the line head is tight and the correct line is fitted; petrol strimmer line must not exceed the guard trimmer. I never fit a metal blade to a machine not built and guarded for one. I clear the area and keep people, children and dogs at least 15 m away. I keep both hands on the handles and the head low, never above waist height, directing debris away from people and cables. I feed line as designed, never by hand while running/live, and do not strim hard against wire, posts or stone. I start the petrol strimmer on firm ground, machine down and head clear; if its head turns at idle I stop and tag it OUT OF USE.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help ☐ Not applicable

8. Hedge cutters - petrol and electric

I check undamaged teeth, tight blade bolts and lubrication as required, keeping the cover on until ready. I check for nests, wire, stakes, posts and cables; I do not cut in bird-nesting season (roughly March-August) unless checked and clear. I keep clear footing and both feet on the ground: no ladders, steps or water butts. I keep both hands on the handles and never defeat controls; I check petrol stop/throttle controls or electric two-hand controls as the manual directs. I keep the blade below shoulder height, away from my body and legs, and cut away from me. If I cannot reach safely from the ground, I do not use this tool for the job. I replace the blade cover for carrying and storage.

☐ Understood ☐ I would like help ☐ Not applicable

What I need next for each tool

Choose the closest fit, taking account of your previous experience and the induction. This helps RVAS arrange support. Only choose A if you understand the applicable checks and feel able to use the machine safely. You can ask for more help at any time.

A I feel ready to use this tool and do not need further help at present.
B I would like a demonstration or refresher before using it.
C I would like supported practice or someone to check my technique before solo use.
D I do not plan to use this tool at present.

Petrol strimmer	☐ A	☐ B	☐ C	☐ D
Electric strimmer	☐ A	☐ B	☐ C	☐ D
Petrol hedge cutter	☐ A	☐ B	☐ C	☐ D
Electric hedge cutter	☐ A	☐ B	☐ C	☐ D

My experience, intended tasks, limits or support wanted - name the relevant tool(s)

One declaration and sign-off

My answers accurately reflect my understanding and the support I would like. I will use the required PPE, follow agreed limits, stop if unsure and report faults or concerns. For B, I will arrange a demonstration or refresher before use; for C, supported practice or a technique check before solo use. This record does not itself authorise solo use.

My signature / typed full name

Keep a copy of the completed record. Contact the Tool Librarian at **rvascontact@gmail.com** for help or corrections. The online version will record submission time automatically; no date entry is needed.